

INDIA'S DPDP ACT, 2023 • A REDESIGN

Consent, *by design.*

Turning DPDP compliance into a moment of trust — the first product surface
Vedantu's parents ever see, and the reason they stay.

PRODUCT

Vedantu • K-12 learning

FOCUS

Children's data + consent

REGULATION

DPDP Act, 2023 (India)

DELIVERABLES

Deck + clickable prototype

Vedantu's consent surface was built for a world *before DPDP*.

A single checkbox at signup covers marketing, analytics, third-party SDKs, WhatsApp nudges, live-class recordings, and personalisation — for learners who are, on our estimate, majority minors. DPDP now demands purpose-bound, revocable, and (for minors) parent-verified consent.

~65%

LEARNERS UNDER 18
(ASSUMED)

1

BLANKET CONSENT
CHECKBOX TODAY

₹250 Cr

MAX PENALTY PER DPDP
BREACH

CONSENT, BY DESIGN

WHY IT MATTERS

- **Legal exposure**
Consent for minors without verifiable parental consent is invalid under DPDP §9.
- **Trust & retention**
Parents are the payer. A creepy first impression kills renewals more than any UX bug.
- **Vendor risk**
~40 third-party SDKs share a single implicit consent. One leak, one headline.
- **Growth cost**
Blanket consent is fragile — one regulator notice can pause ads, analytics, and ML overnight.

Assumptions. User-age mix from public Vedantu disclosures + BYJU'S / Unacademy comparables; SDK count from AppFigures-style teardowns. Not internal data.

MOCK DATA · ASSUMPTIONS DISCLOSED



Priya Menon

Parent · payer · gatekeeper

39 · BENGALURU · WORKS IN HR

"I signed him up in five minutes. I never read what I agreed to. Now I keep getting WhatsApp calls from tutors."

JOBS TO BE DONE

- ✓ Make sure my kid learns without being tracked or spammed
- ✓ Understand what the app knows about my child
- ✓ Feel in control without becoming an IT admin

PAIN POINTS

- ✗ No visibility into what data is collected
- ✗ Marketing calls to child's number
- ✗ No easy way to delete data if we churn



Aarav Menon

Learner · 14 · Class 9

STUDIES 2 HRS/DAY · USES PARENT'S PHONE + OWN TABLET

"I just want the class to start. Every pop-up feels like homework."

JOBS TO BE DONE

- ✓ Attend live class quickly, without friction
- ✓ Get recommendations that feel relevant, not creepy
- ✓ Not feel spied on by teachers or friends

PAIN POINTS

- ✗ Cannot legally give consent under DPDP
- ✗ Doesn't understand what he's agreeing to
- ✗ Session recordings shared without clear notice

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

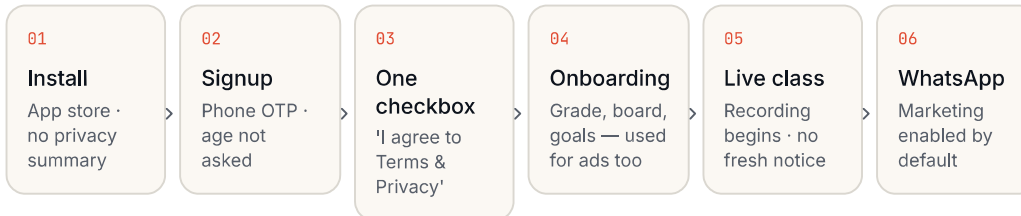
Design for the parent. Delight the learner.

The parent decides. The child feels the friction. Both must be respected in every screen we ship.

One tap today collects *nine* distinct purposes' worth of data.

The current signup journey — reconstructed from a fresh install — bundles consent with the "Continue" button, then never surfaces it again.

FIRST-RUN JOURNEY (ASSUMED)



CONSENT-FATIGUE HEATMAP · ATTENTION DECAY PER STEP



WHERE WE FALL SHORT OF DPDP

§6 · NOTICE



No itemised, plain-language notice at collection

§7 · PURPOSE LIMITATION



Learning data reused for retargeting ads

§9 · CHILDREN



No age gate → no verifiable parental consent

§11 · RIGHT TO ACCESS & ERASE



No self-serve data export or delete

§6(4) · WITHDRAWAL



Consent easy to give, hard to take back

Section refs: DPDP Act, 2023. Findings from black-box teardown of current Android app + public policy pages.

Consent is a *product*, not a legal form.

Every platform that has ever tried to bury consent has paid for it — in churn, in fines, in reputation. Every platform that made consent *tangible* converted it into trust, and trust into retention.

THE OPPORTUNITY FOR VEDANTU

Be the first Indian EdTech that treats a parent's consent like a product feature — not a footer link.

APPLE · APP TRACKING TRANSPARENCY

Just-in-time, single purpose, plain-language.

→ Trust > opt-in rate. ~75% opt-out and Apple still won.

GOOGLE · FAMILY LINK

Parent as first-class account holder for minors.

→ Give parents a real dashboard, not a legal PDF.

GDPR / DMA COOKIE BANNERS

Bundled 'Accept all' with dark patterns.

→ Cautionary tale — enforcement caught up. Don't repeat.

WHATSAPP · 2021 POLICY

Confusing forced consent → mass exodus to Signal.

→ Consent copy is a growth surface. Get it wrong once.

SPOTIFY · PRIVACY SETTINGS

Granular but buried five taps deep.

→ Discoverability matters as much as granularity.

UBER · PRIVACY CENTER

Single hub for data, deletion, export.

→ Users trust products that show their own homework.

Three layers. One promise: *no data without a reason.*

An age-aware consent architecture that unbundles purposes, elevates parents, and makes every data right one tap away.

DATA MINIMISATION

Collect only what a purpose demands

PURPOSE BINDING

Toggle-level control per use

VERIFIABLE CONSENT

DigiLocker + OTP + payment signal

FULL USER RIGHTS

Access · export · erase · withdraw

01

Parent Vault

A parent-owned account that supervises up to 4 child profiles. Parents verify once via Aadhaar-linked OTP + DigiLocker signal (fallback: payment-instrument match).

- Verifiable parental consent (DPDP §9)
- Portable across siblings
- Auto-expires at learner's 18th birthday

02

Purpose-Bound Consent

Nine data purposes, each with a plain-language card, a preview of what it enables, and a live toggle. Nothing is pre-selected except what the service literally cannot run without.

- Essential · Personalisation · Recommendations
- Marketing · WhatsApp · Session recording
- Analytics · Third-party SDKs · Research

03

Rights Console

A single 'Your Data' screen inside Settings. Download in JSON+PDF, delete within 30 days, or pause specific purposes with one tap. Every state change emits a receipt.

- Self-serve export & erase
- Consent receipts (audit-grade)
- Withdrawal is as easy as giving consent

Built for the moment a parent is about to *tap Skip.*

Progressive disclosure, plain language (English + Hindi), and micro-copy that treats the parent as an adult. No dark patterns, no pre-ticked boxes, no scare tactics.

Age gate

Fair, unmissable, once

Ask a parent

Handoff, not a wall

Purpose toggles

One card at a time

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

- Just-in-time · never at signup wall
- One purpose per card · one decision at a time
- Symmetry of choice · "Accept" ≡ "Not now"
- Preview the value before asking

[Open live prototype ↗](#)

NORTH STAR

Valid Consent Coverage

VCC

Share of monthly active learners whose current data use is backed by a *valid, fresh, purpose-matched* consent — and, for minors, a verified parent.

VCC = (MAUs with valid consent for every active purpose) / (Total MAUs)
Target: 92% by Q4 · Floor: 85% · Failure: <80%

Leading
Consent-flow
completion

Lagging
Renewal · complaint
volume

Cadence
Daily · segment-weekly

SUPPORTING

Purpose-level opt-in rate

Opt-ins ÷ eligible prompts (per purpose)

Tells us which purposes users actually want — informs data-minimisation calls.

SUPPORTING

Time-to-first-class after consent

Median seconds from consent submit → class join

Consent should not slow learning down. Ever.

GUARDRAIL

Support tickets citing 'consent' / 'privacy'

Weekly count, normalised per 10k MAU

Rising tickets = confusing UX or dark-pattern smell. Investigate within 48h.

SUPPORTING

Parent verification success rate

Verified parents ÷ minor signups reaching parent step

Guards against a broken handoff killing minor onboarding.

GUARDRAIL

Signup → 1st-class conversion

Conversion delta vs. control cohort

Red-line at -3pp. Anything worse pauses rollout.

GUARDRAIL

Consent-withdrawal rate

Toggles switched off ÷ toggles ever on

Healthy is 2-5%. A spike signals a trust event we must diagnose.

VALID CONSENT COVERAGE

91.4%

vs. 92% target

+3.1 wk/wk

PARENT VERIFICATION RATE

82%

minor cohort

+1.4 wk/wk

TIME-TO-1ST-CLASS

47s

p50, post-consent

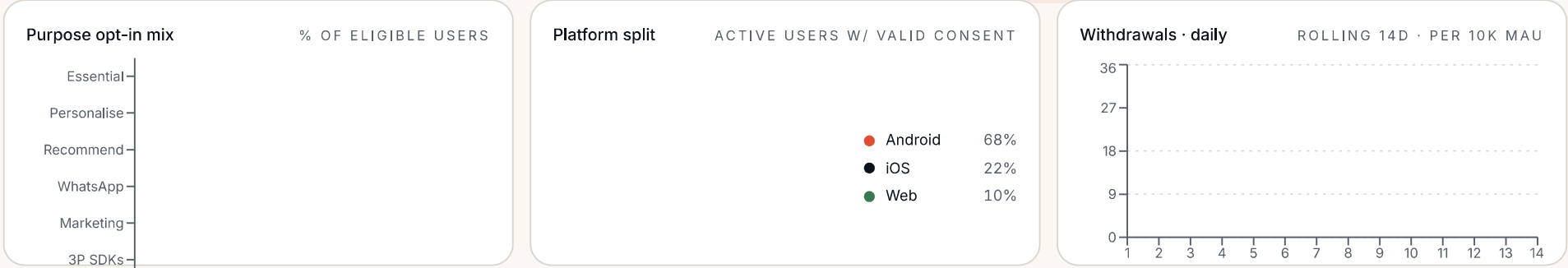
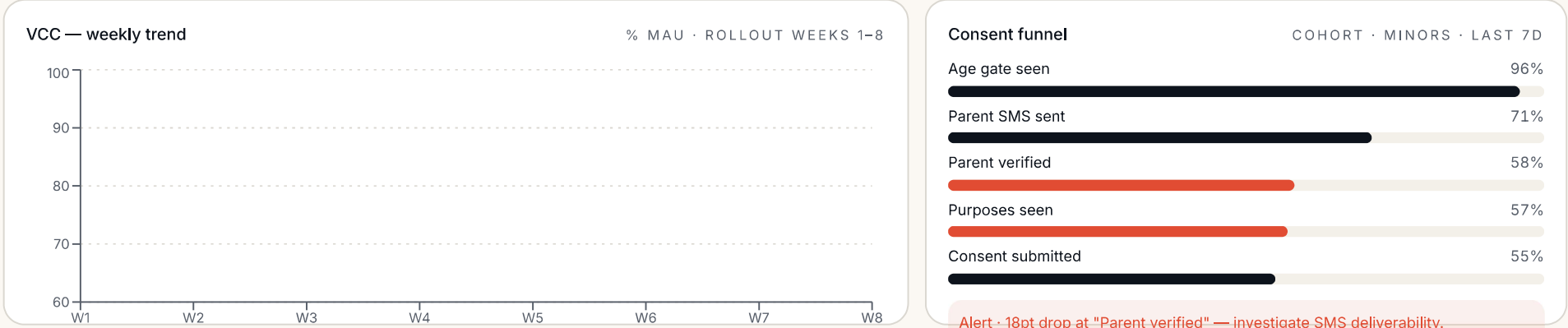
-6s wk/wk

WITHDRAWAL RATE

3.1%

watch bucket

+0.4 wk/wk



SCENARIO

VCC drops 15% in week 3 — with no release.

"No release" is a hypothesis, not a fact. First step is to falsify it: pull deploy log, config-flag history, SDK version diffs, vendor status. Then structure the search.

PLAYBOOK (FIRST 24H)

1. Segment the drop: platform × geo × cohort × age.
2. Diff pipelines + configs vs. last known-good.
3. Ping vendor status pages (SMS, DigiLocker, CDN).
4. Sample 30 support tickets qualitatively.
5. Compute counterfactual — did MAU move, or just numerator?
6. If unclear at 24h, invoke privacy incident protocol.

HYPOTHESIS TREE · PRIOR PROBABILITY SHOWN

Measurement 20%

- Consent-event pipeline dropping rows
- Timezone bug at rollover
- New client not emitting receipts

Supply — external 35%

- SMS/OTP vendor outage → parent verification failing
- DigiLocker rate-limits triggered
- Play Store forced update rolled out silently

Demand — user side 30%

- Board-exam cohort churn (seasonal, ~ May–July)
- Media event about EdTech privacy → withdrawals
- Competitor launched aggressive campaign

Product 15%

- Config change flipped a default toggle
- Silent SDK update expanded data scope
- A/B experiment on adjacent flow leaked

NEXT STEP · IF MEASUREMENT

Freeze dashboard, replay events, publish correction — no user-facing action.

NEXT STEP · IF EXTERNAL

Fail over SMS vendor, degrade gracefully to email-link, extend consent grace window.

NEXT STEP · IF PRODUCT / CONFIG

Roll back within 30 min. Post-mortem within 7 days. Notify DPO.

Ship in *phases*. Rollback in *minutes*.

Consent copy for minors is not fully A/B-testable — we cannot legally give "worse" consent to a control group. So we split the world into what we can experiment on, and what we can only observe.

✓ Safe to A/B test

Micro-copy, screen order, illustration presence, plain-language layer, notification cadence.

✗ Not A/B-testable

Whether consent is asked. Whether parent verification is required. Data scope of a purpose.

✓ Method for the untestable

Pre-post analysis, synthetic control (unaffected geo), qualitative research with 20 parents per phase.

PHASED ROLLOUT · GATES ADVANCE ONLY ON GREEN

1	Week 0	Dogfood	Vedantu employees + kids · full flow	GATE · ZERO P0/P1 DEFECTS
2	Week 1	Internal QA + legal	DPO + external counsel sign-off	GATE · DPIA PUBLISHED
3	Week 2	1% shadow	New signups only · Bengaluru + Hyd.	GATE · VCC ≥ BASELINE - 2PP
4	Week 3	5% ramp	Add existing minor cohort · re-consent	GATE · COMPLAINT RATE FLAT
5	Week 5	20% ramp	All new signups nationwide	GATE · TIME-TO-CLASS DELTA ≤ +5S
6	Week 8	100% GA	Migrate legacy accounts · 30-day window	GATE · VCC ≥ 85%

ROLLBACK SLA

< 15 min

single feature-flag

KILL SWITCH

Server-side

no app update needed

CONSENT GRACE

30 days

for legacy migration

CONSENT, BY DESIGN

MOCK DATA · ASSUMPTIONS DISCLOSED

TRADE-OFF WE ACCEPT

A slower signup, in exchange for a *longer relationship*.

Every EdTech in India will eventually be forced here by regulation. The only question is whether we arrive as a defendant or as the category's trust benchmark.

12-MONTH VISION

- Parent Vault becomes the account primitive.
- Consent receipts exportable to DigiLocker.
- "Vedantu Trust" — a public transparency report, quarterly.
- A privacy score in-app, visible to every parent.

BUSINESS

Adding a parent step could shave 2–4pp off minor signup conversion.

→ Reserve 30-day grace + one-tap resume; measure LTV, not just conversion.

ENGINEERING

Consent must propagate to ~40 SDKs and back-end services in real time.

→ Central Consent Service (CCS) with pub-sub; hard fail-closed on unknown state.

PRIVACY DARK-PATTERN RISK

Product/growth teams pressure to pre-tick, pre-nudge, pre-select.

→ Design review + external counsel gate; auditable receipts make cheating expensive.

CHILD SAFETY

Bad actor could pose as parent via SMS spoofing.

→ Payment-instrument match + device pairing + anomaly detection on verification.

ACCESSIBILITY & LITERACY

Plain-language copy still assumes reading fluency.

→ Voice-over consent (Hindi/English), 11 Indic language rollout by Q4.

INTERNATIONAL EXPANSION

GDPR / COPPA thresholds differ from DPDP §9.

→ Locale-aware purpose registry; consent artefacts portable to EU / US standards.

